JAPHET BENEFOH

Accra, Ghana | +233538000121 | japhet.benefoh@fishcom.gov.gh / jcanbenefoh10@gmail.com | Administrative Manager | BA. Political Science, University of Ghana – Second Class Upper (UK 2:1 Equivalent)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Public administrator at Ghana's Fisheries Commission with 4 years at the frontline of blue economy governance. I oversee compliance for 120+ fishing vessels and coordinate data verification across 15 landing sites, engaging 400+ fisherfolk and women processors. My work focuses on state-citizen relations, food security, and GESI-designing gender-disaggregated data systems to address women's exclusion from fisheries co-management.

PROPOSED RESEARCH

The Political Economy of the Blue Economy in Ghana: Sustainability, Food Security and Gender Justice. This research examines how fisheries enforcement regimes impact artisanal food security and how gender-blind data systems exclude women (60% of post-harvest labour) from co-management. It draws comparative lessons from the EU Common Fisheries Policy for ECOWAS blue economy governance.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Political Economy of Development & Blue Economy Governance; Fisheries Policy, Food Security & Informality; Gender Equality and Social Inclusion (GESI) in Natural Resource Governance; Public Administration and State-Citizen Relations in West Africa; Environmental Justice and Common-Pool Resources

EDUCATION

University of Ghana, Legon – BA. POLITICAL SCIENCE **Sept 2010 - June 2014**

| Second Class Upper Division | CGPA: 3.20/4.0 – Scholaro Equivalent | (UK 2:1 Equivalent) |

Relevant Coursework: Public Administration, Public Policy Analysis, Political Economy, Comparative Politics, Research Methods, Public Finance, Government and Leadership

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Administrative Manager | Fisheries Commission, Accra, Ghana | Feb 2022 – Present

- Oversee regulatory documentation and licensing for 120+ industrial and semi-industrial fishing vessels annually, ensuring compliance with Ghana's Fisheries Act and closed-season directives.
- Coordinate field monitoring and data verification across 15 artisanal landing site; conduct semi-structured interviews and stakeholder mapping with fishers, women processors, and traditional authorities.

- Prepare 24+ analytical and administrative reports annually for senior management, directly informing the review of Ghana Fisheries Management Plan (2022-2026)
- Facilitate 12+ multi-stakeholder dialogues annually between state officials and fishing communities, translating technical regulations into Twi and Ga to improve compliance and de-escalate conflicts.

Program Assistant |Agrihouse Foundation, Accra, Ghana | June 2019 – Dec 2021

Climate-Smart Agriculture & Rural Livelihoods

- Supported design and delivery of climate-smart agriculture and market linkage programs reaching 350+ smallholder farmers across Greater Accra, Eastern and Central regions.
- Co-facilitated 15 farmer field schools on value addition and sustainable practices; drafted 10+ field reports and needs assessments focusing on barriers faced by women farmers in accessing extension services.

Teacher – Government & Social Studies |Bechem Business College, Ahafo Region | June 2016 – May 2018

- Taught governance, civic education and citizenship to 150+ SHS students annually; developed curriculum linking local governance to everyday state-citizen interactions. Mentored 40 WASSCE candidates.

National Service Personnel |Social Security and National Insurance Trust (SSNIT), Accra, Ghana | Sept 2014 – Sept 2015

- Supported documentation and verification of social security and pension records
- Assisted contributors and pensioners with enquiries at the front desk
- Gained foundational understanding of Ghana's social protection system and challenges in state delivery of pensions

FELLOWSHIPS, INTERNATIONAL TRAINING & LEADERSHIP

KOICA Youth Leaders Program – Government of the Republic of Korea Aug 2 -15, 2026

- Competitively selected among 25 Ghanaian youth leaders nationwide. Intensive residential training on SDGs, Global Cooperation, and Korea's Development Experience. Delivered Knowledge-sharing session for 20+ colleagues at Fisheries Commission on integrating SDGs and youth leadership in blue economy governance.

GESI Step-Down Training – Fisheries Commission, Accra – Ghana Sept 2025

- Selected participant, Regional GESI Training. Applied learning to pilot gender-sensitive data collection tools for artisanal fisheries monitoring in Central Region.

SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

Research & Policy: | Qualitative Fieldwork & Semi-Structured Interviewing | Stakeholder Mapping| Policy Analysis & Report Writing| Gender-Disaggregated data collection & analysis |

Technical: |MS Office Advanced | Goggle Workspace | Basic SPSS | Data Verification & Electronic Filing Systems |

Languages: | English (Native Proficiency) | Twi (Native) | Ga (Fieldwork Proficiency) |

FIELD RESEARCH, VOLUNTEER & COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Volunteer Researcher & Community Organizer | Plastic Punch & Ghana Youth Environmental Movement | June 2018 – Nov 2018

- Conducted 15 coastal field observations and clean-ups at Jamestown, Laboma, Chorkor ; removed 500+ kg plastic waste / ghost nets; engaged 200+ youth and fisherfolk on marine pollution and climate justice

Volunteer | FARIAD (Foundation for Animal Rights and Indigenous Development) Jan 2019 – May 2019

- Supported livelihood and environmental sensitization campaigns reaching 100+ vulnerable groups.

REFERENCES

Available upon request.